

# The Deck Cost Guide.

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Most deck pricing online quotes **materials only** — then the real bids land at double. Here's the honest math, using manufacturer material data plus what installation actually adds.

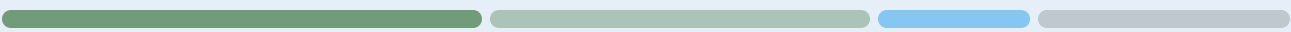
## Step 1 — Materials

Composite decking boards (Deckorators, Trex, TimberTech) run roughly **\$8–14 per sq ft** for the boards themselves. Add the substructure (pressure-treated framing, footings, hardware) and railing, and all-in materials land around **\$20–30 per sq ft** for a typical composite deck.

## Step 2 — Add 50–100% for installation

Industry-wide, labor runs 50–60% of a finished deck's total cost — professional installation adds **\$15–35 per sq ft** on top of materials. The rule of thumb: take your materials number and add 50–100%. A \$12,000 materials list is a \$18,000–24,000 finished deck. Height, slope, access, and design complexity decide which end you land on.

### WHERE THE MONEY ACTUALLY GOES



Substructure + its labor ~38% · decking & railing labor ~30% · railing material ~12% · decking boards & fasteners ~20%. The boards you agonize over are a fifth of the bill.

## What that means by deck size

Installed composite, single level, with railing — national data; Front Range labor tends toward the upper half.

| Size              | Materials           | Installed           |
|-------------------|---------------------|---------------------|
| 12×16 (192 sq ft) | \$4,500 – \$6,500   | \$8,000 – \$13,000  |
| 16×20 (320 sq ft) | \$7,000 – \$10,500  | \$13,000 – \$25,000 |
| 20×24 (480 sq ft) | \$10,500 – \$15,500 | \$19,000 – \$37,000 |

For calibration: the 2025 Zonda Cost vs Value report puts the national-average 16×20 composite deck addition at about \$25,000 — and wood at about \$18,000.

## The add-ons bids include (and calculators don't)

|                                  |                         |
|----------------------------------|-------------------------|
| Railing, installed               | <b>\$20–60 / lin ft</b> |
| Stairs, installed                | <b>\$150–400 / step</b> |
| Concrete footings (4–8 per deck) | <b>\$150–600 each</b>   |
| Permit fees, south Denver metro  | <b>\$200–500</b>        |
| Tear-out of an old deck          | <b>\$1,500–3,500</b>    |

These are planning numbers from national cost surveys and manufacturer calculators — not a Haka bid. Elevated decks, walk-outs, and covered structures run above these ranges. When you're ready for a real number, that estimate is free: 720-589-5680.